

10.6 “Deming Wheel” and “Shewhart Cycle”

The Deming Wheel, also known as the PDCA Cycle (Plan-Do-Check-Act), is a continuous improvement framework used to enhance processes, products, and business operations systematically. It was popularized by Dr. W. Edwards Deming.

1. Plan (Identify your problems)

The first step is to identify and understand the problem or opportunity. This involves analyzing key data sources such as customer feedback, market trends, competitor performance, and business metrics.

For example, if you own a café and notice a drop in foot traffic, you need to determine the root cause. Is it due to increased competition, changing customer preferences, lack of brand awareness, or ineffective marketing? Identifying these factors helps you develop a focused strategy.

Gathering insights from customer surveys, online reviews, and social media engagement provides a clearer picture of the challenge. By defining the problem precisely, you create a solid foundation for effective solutions rather than addressing symptoms superficially.

4. Act (Implement the Best Solution)

Based on your findings, focus your efforts on the most successful strategies. If a particular marketing channel or campaign delivers the highest foot traffic, allocate more resources to it. If certain efforts underperform, refine or replace them accordingly.

For instance, if Instagram engagement drives strong results, you could expand content creation and influencer collaborations. If foot traffic remains low despite marketing efforts, it may be time to revisit your business model or explore new revenue streams.

